

CITY :

Civic Innovation Through You



CITY is not merely a platform for gathering citizens' opinions,
but a platform designed to build a participatory structure where citizens and the administration build trust together.



Many citizens are interested in urban issues.
But few actually speak up.

Because the perception that
"even if I speak up, nothing will change"
is strong.

85%

According to the survey, 85% of citizens feel
that public institutions do not consider their opinions important.

Because the perception that
"even if I speak up, nothing will change" is strong.



On existing platforms, opinions are received.

However, it is not clear how things proceed after that.

Participation ends as a one-time event. Trust is not built.



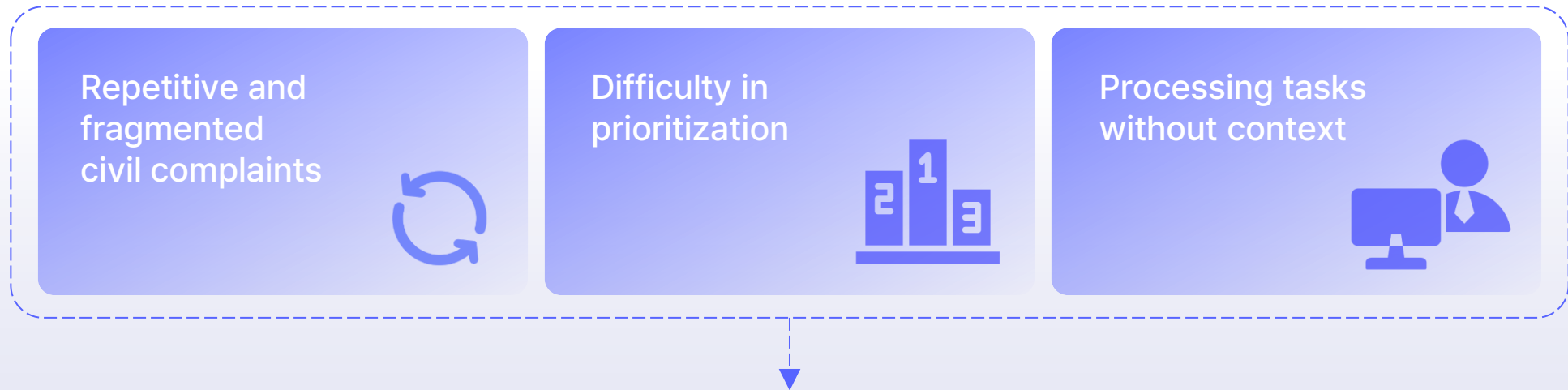
According to the survey, 85% of citizens feel
that public institutions do not consider their opinions important.



What about from
the perspective of public officials?

Looking at systems like NYC 311,

a small number of issues account for the majority of complaints, yet every request is handled as an individual case. As a result,



As a result, rather than addressing the root cause,

Civil servants end up spending their time on '**throughput management**'

Looking at systems like NYC 311,

a small number of issues account for the majority of complaints,
yet every request is handled as an individual case. As a result,

So what needs and pain points does our target audience have?

To find out, we created target personas.

As a result, rather than addressing the root cause,

Civil servants end up spending their time on 'throughput management'

David Kim

Age : 54

Location : Bellevue

Former IT industry professional

Language : English, Korean

Pain Point

Civic Engagement Platform Oversimplified

Survey-oriented structure a lack of depth of opinion

Policy suggestions do not connect to execution phase Lack of space for technical and administrative context

Needs

Refined Policy Proposition Structure

Visualizing the connection between citizen opinion and administrative logic

Idea - Review - Clear reflection/pending flow





Lisa Chen

Age : 35

Location : Bellevue

City Transportation Officer

Language : English

Pain Point

Too many fragmented reports across channels

No clear signal of collective priority

Difficult to communicate progress back to citizens

Public trust decreases when feedback is delayed

Needs

Clear prioritization signals from citizens

A transparent way to show review & progress

Reduced repetitive and duplicate reports

A single interface to manage civic feedback

The background of the slide features the silhouettes of a man and a woman in profile, facing right. The man is on the left, and the woman is on the right, slightly behind him. They are both looking forward, suggesting a shared vision or focus. The entire image is set against a solid blue background.

The more actively they engage with urban issues, the better the city becomes,
and the more efficiently the administration functions.

That is why we need to encourage greater citizen participation.

HOW?

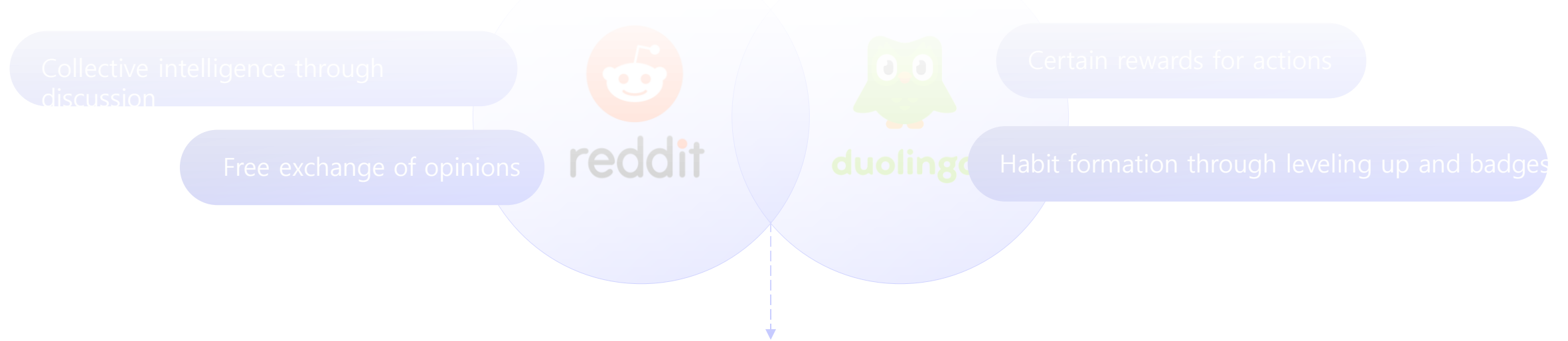
Then how can we increase people's participation?

We found hints for solutions in various success stories.

We analyzed the factors behind their success, and various success stories like Reddit and Duolingo provided us with diverse inspiration.

[Success Stories]



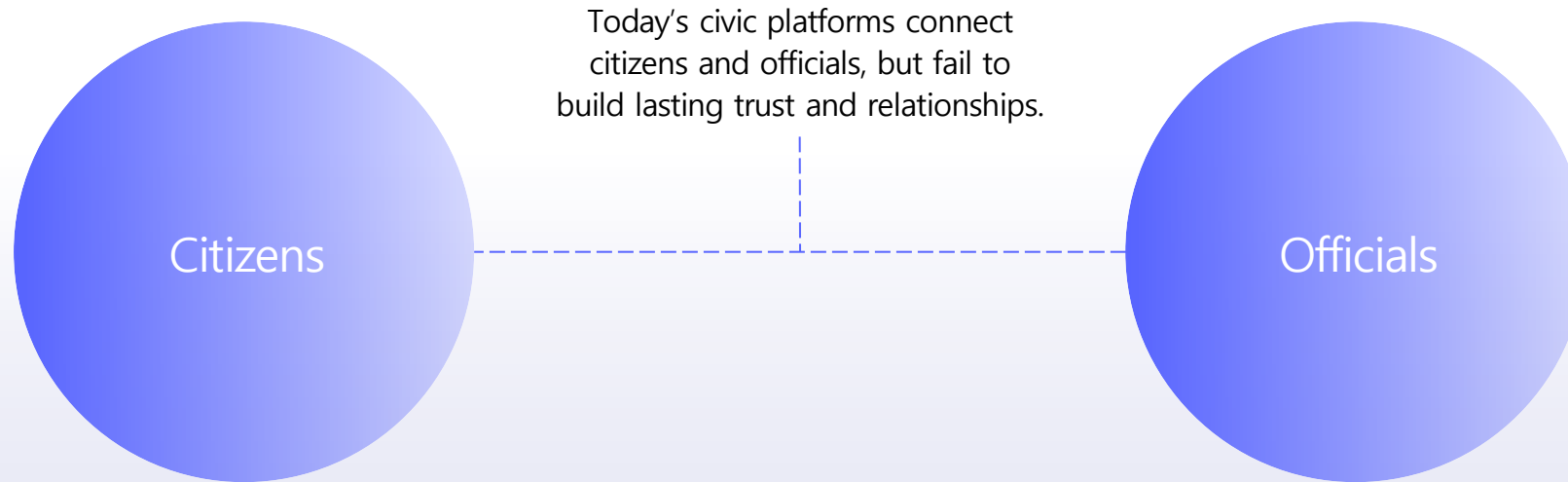


Common points

A structure where participation is rewarded

The commonality between the two platforms is that they created a structure where people's actions or participation yield visible rewards. This is a characteristic of social networking services and gamification. We were affected by that structure.

[OVERVIEW]



Citizens raise everyday issues, but rarely see what happens next, while officials receive requests without full context or shared priorities. As a result, participation becomes one-time and repetitive, and trust is never meaningfully accumulated. This project aims to address this gap by proposing a new participation model where citizens and officials grow together.



Therefore, we propose a platform that incorporates Insight,
a structure where participation is rewarded.

CITY :

Civic Innovation Through You

FUNCTION - CITIZEN

Submit Idea

- A space where citizens directly propose ideas/opinions
- Emphasizing that this is 'proposal-centered participation' rather than passive complaints

Discussions

- A Reddit-style discussion space
- Citizens exchanging opinions with each other and with the administration within context

Polls

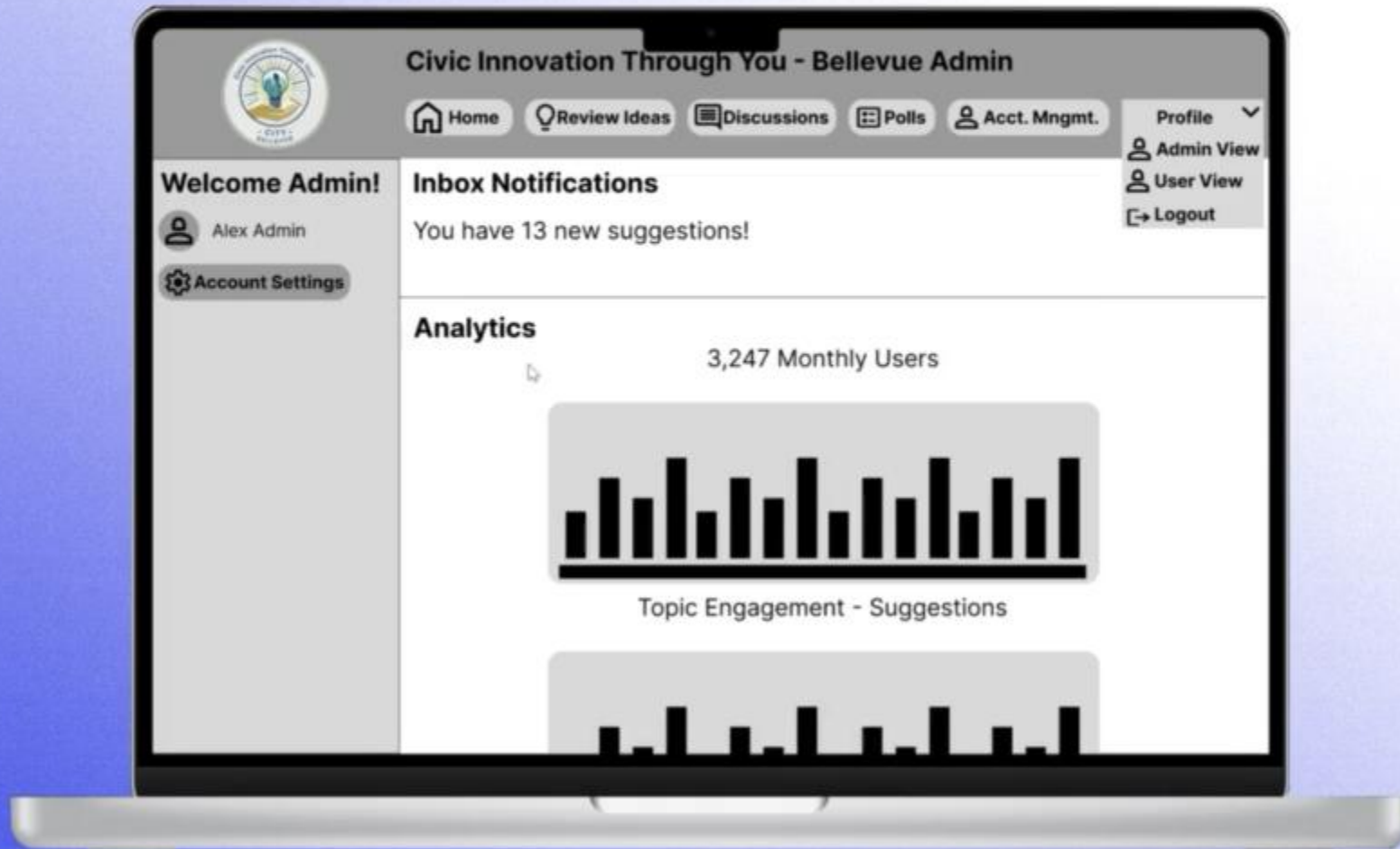
- A structure where cities ask citizens directly
- Rapid opinion gathering
+ Lower participation barriers

Leader Board

- Participation-based ranking
- Visualizes "who contributed the most"
- Encourages sustained participation



FUNCTION - OFFICIAL



[Gamification Structure : Badges & Ranking]

Utilizing gamification—a strategy that applies game elements and design principles to non-game contexts to drive user engagement, motivation, and immersion—to heighten participants' interest.

Badges → Participation



[Effects]

- Earned by taking action
 - Submitting ideas
 - Commenting on discussions
 - Participating in polls
- Encourages early and continuous participation

Ranking → Impact



[Effects]

- Increases only when a citizen's idea is adopted
- Reflects real civic impact, not activity volume
- Helps identify trusted contributors

[User Location Verification Process]

a A three-step validation mechanism to confirm local eligibility

Request GPS Location Permission

Collect real-time location during sign-up

- 1 Request location access during sign-up
- 2 Capture current GPS coordinates
- 3 If denied, guide to address-based verification

Location Check

For the entered address, check the current location

For the entered address (lat/long coordinates)

Check if the current GPS coordinates are within the threshold

the threshold

Verification & Control

Verifies the entered address and the regions

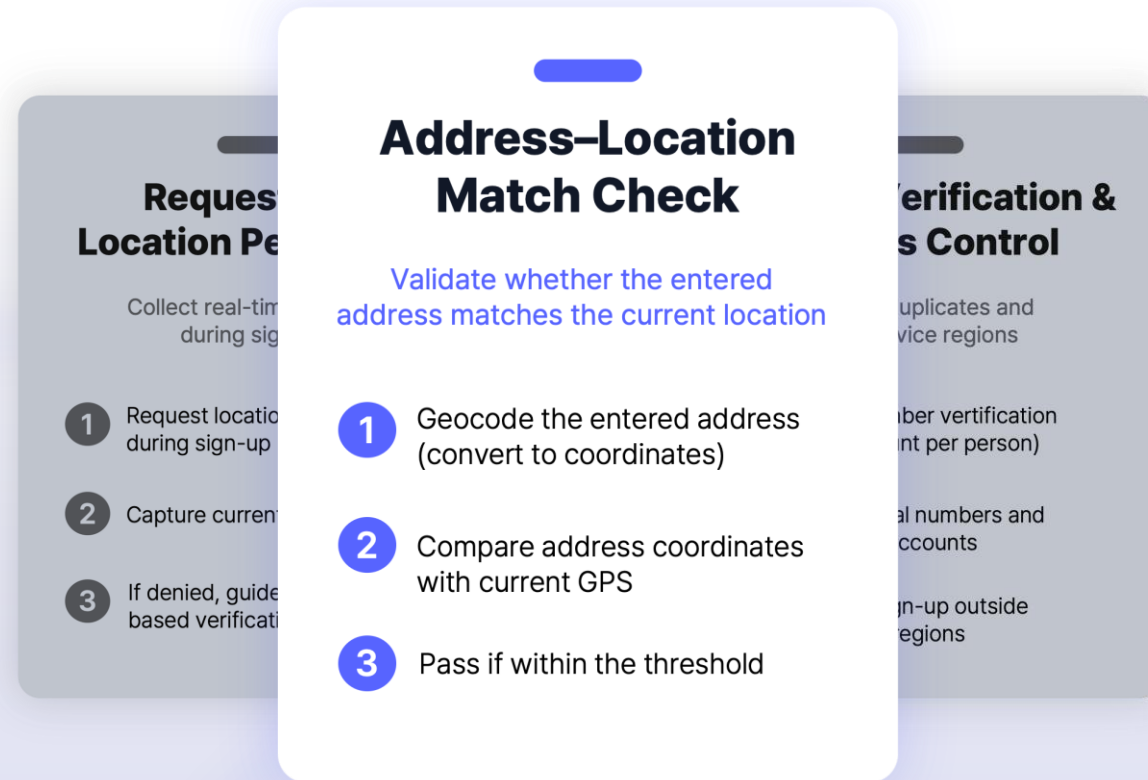
For verification (per person)

Numbers and counts

Sign-up outside regions

[User Location Verification Process]

a A three-step validation mechanism to confirm local eligibility



[User Location Verification Process]

a A three-step validation mechanism to confirm local eligibility

Request Location Permission

Collect real-time location data during sign-up

- 1 Request location permission during sign-up
- 2 Capture current location
- 3 If denied, guide user to location settings for device-based verification

Address-Geocode Match

Validate whether the provided address matches the geocoded location

- 1 Geocode the provided address (convert to coordinates)
- 2 Compare address with current Geolocation
- 3 Pass if within 100m

Identity Verification & Access Control

Prevent duplicates and limit service regions

- 1 Phone number verification (one account per person)
- 2 Block virtual numbers and duplicate accounts
- 3 Restrict sign-up outside approved regions

[What Makes CITY Different]

Why Existing Platforms Fall Short

Unintended Use Bias

Platforms are used differently across generations. Gen Z avoids Facebook, while Gen X still relies on it — creating unintended participation bias.

Ownership & Political Risk

Platform leadership and policies can change. After Elon Musk acquired Twitter, many users left due to political and moderation concerns.

Risk of Social Irrelevance

Platforms can lose relevance over time. Myspace was once dominant but was eventually replaced by other social media platforms.

Open Platforms Are Not Neutral Spaces

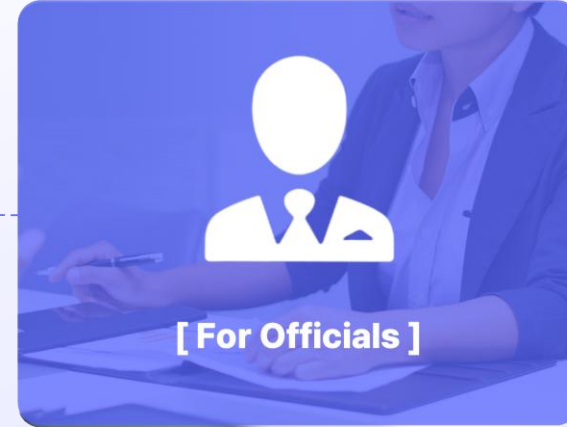
On platforms like Reddit, anyone can post. This risks shifting local discussions toward polarized politics and increases the moderation burden.

[What Makes CITY Different]

CITY is not a general social platform.
It is a city-owned civic system designed to balance citizen voice and official responsibility.

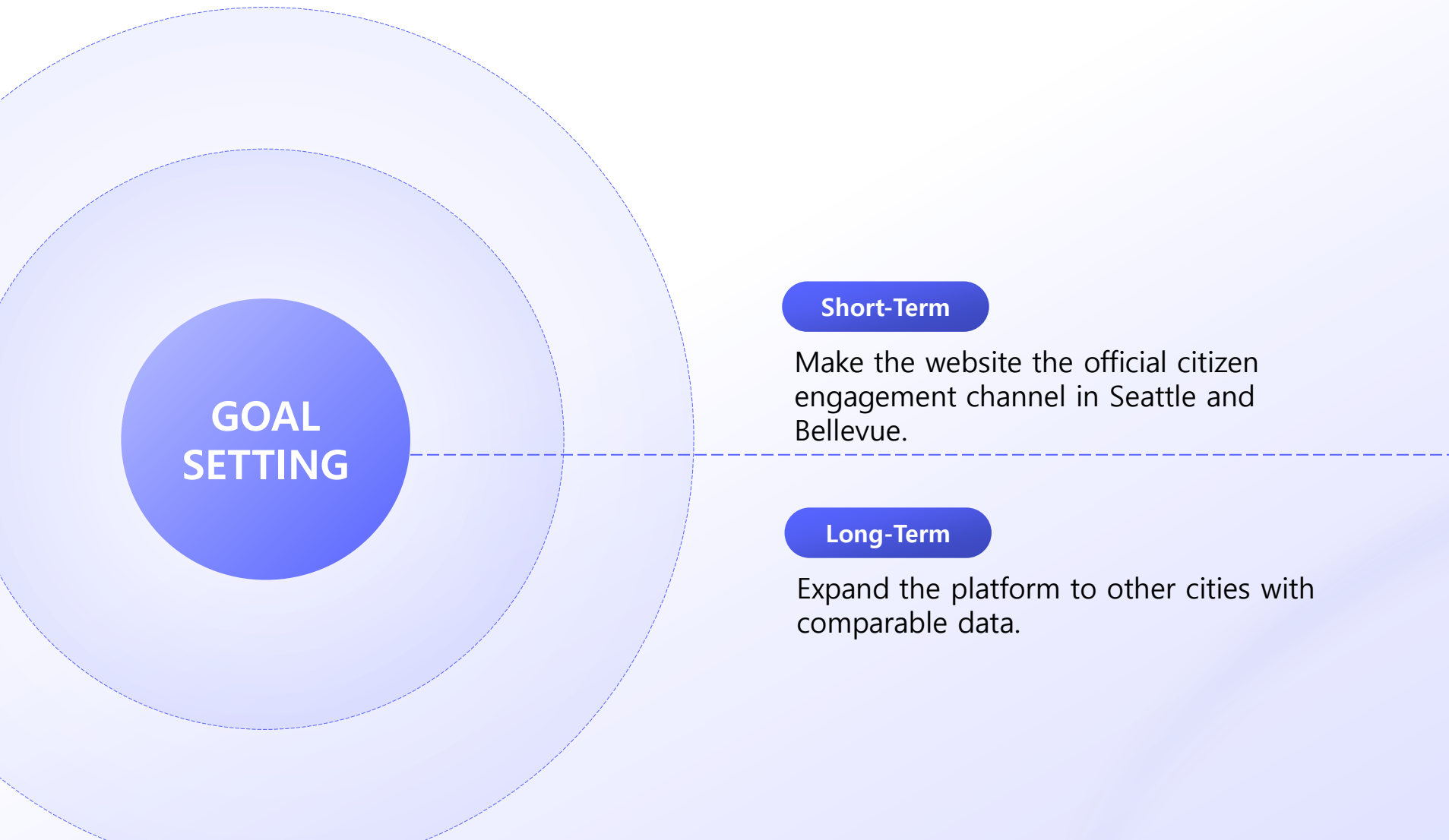


Clear understanding of what the city is asking
Local, issue-focused discussions
Visible feedback and progress from the city

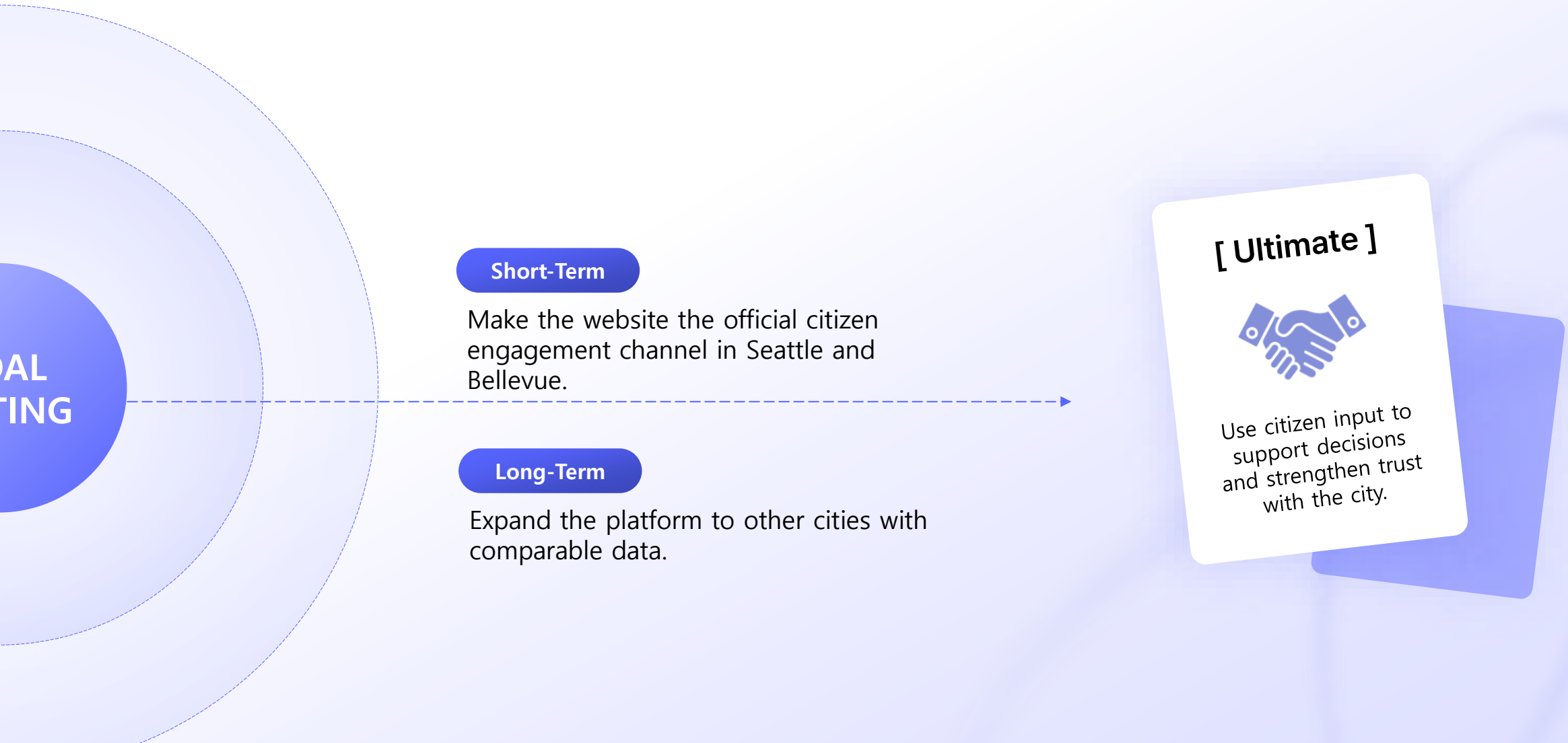


Structured and scoped conversations
Reduced moderation burden
Actionable, consolidated insights instead of noise

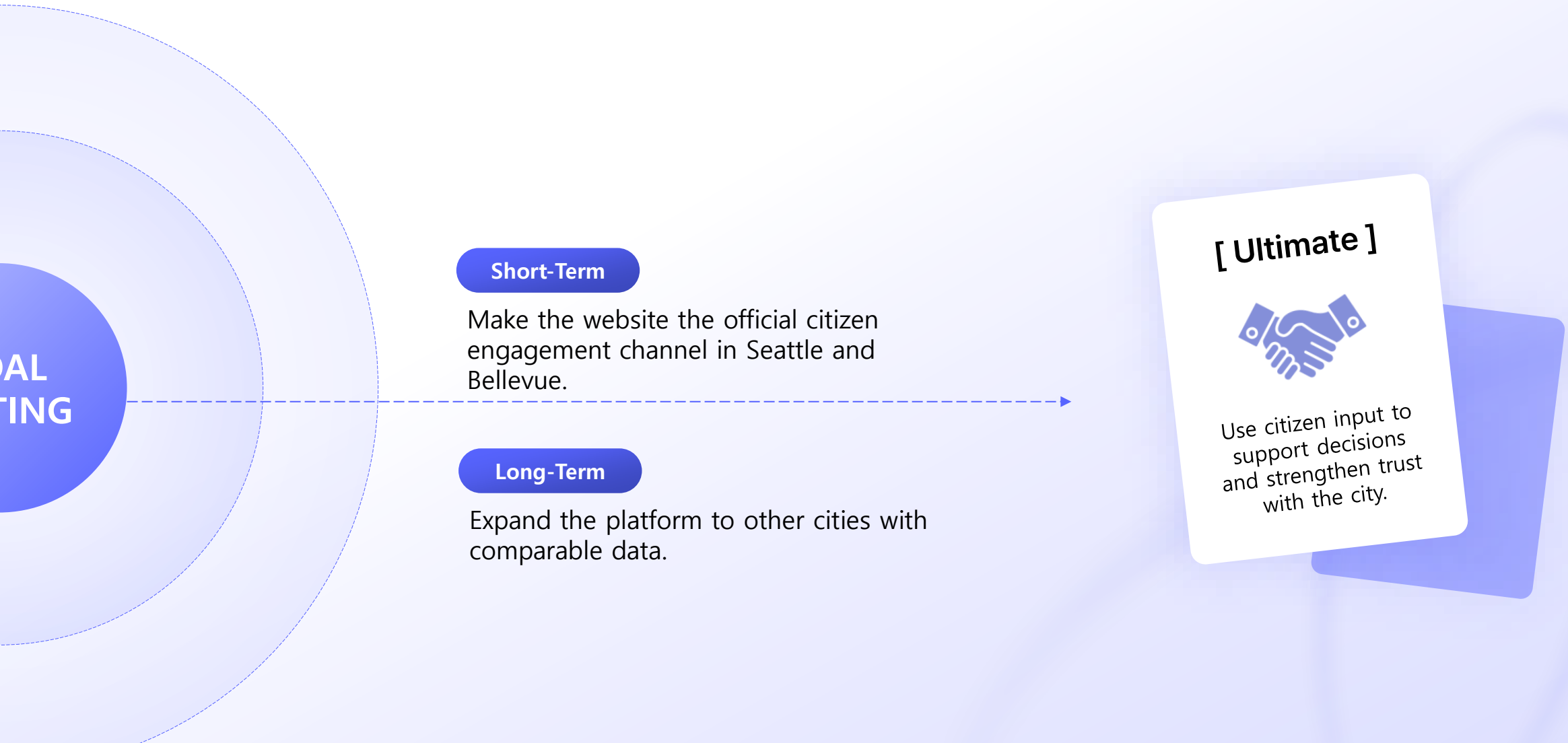
[Business Model : Goal Setting]



[Business Model : Goal Setting]



[Business Model : Goal Setting]

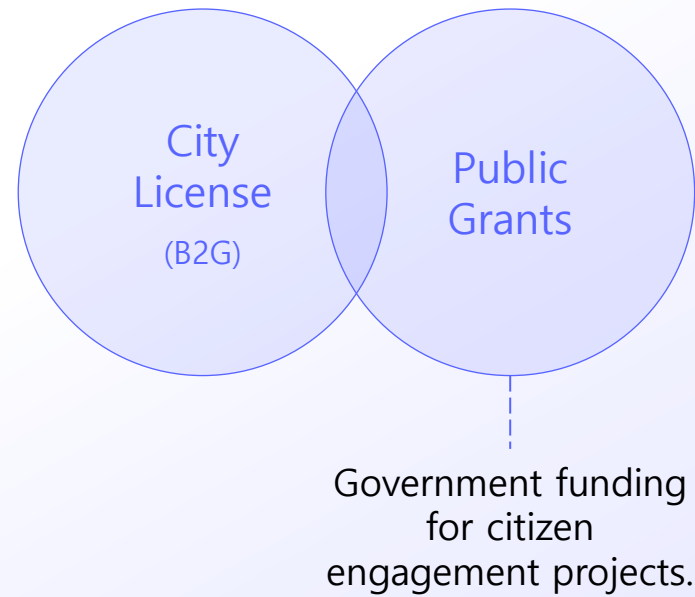


[Business Model : Funding Sources]

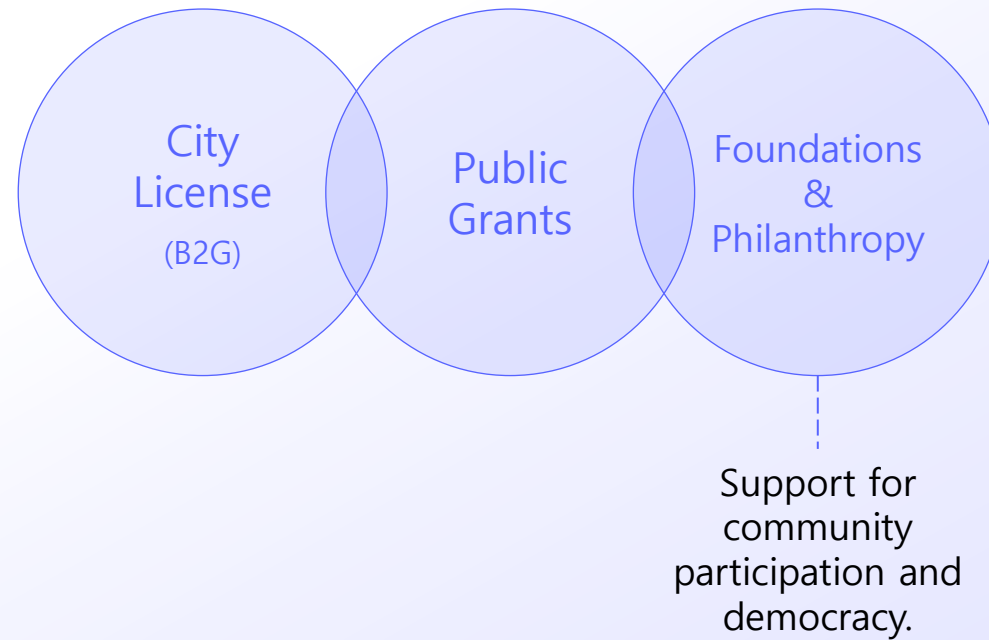


Annual fees from
city adoption.

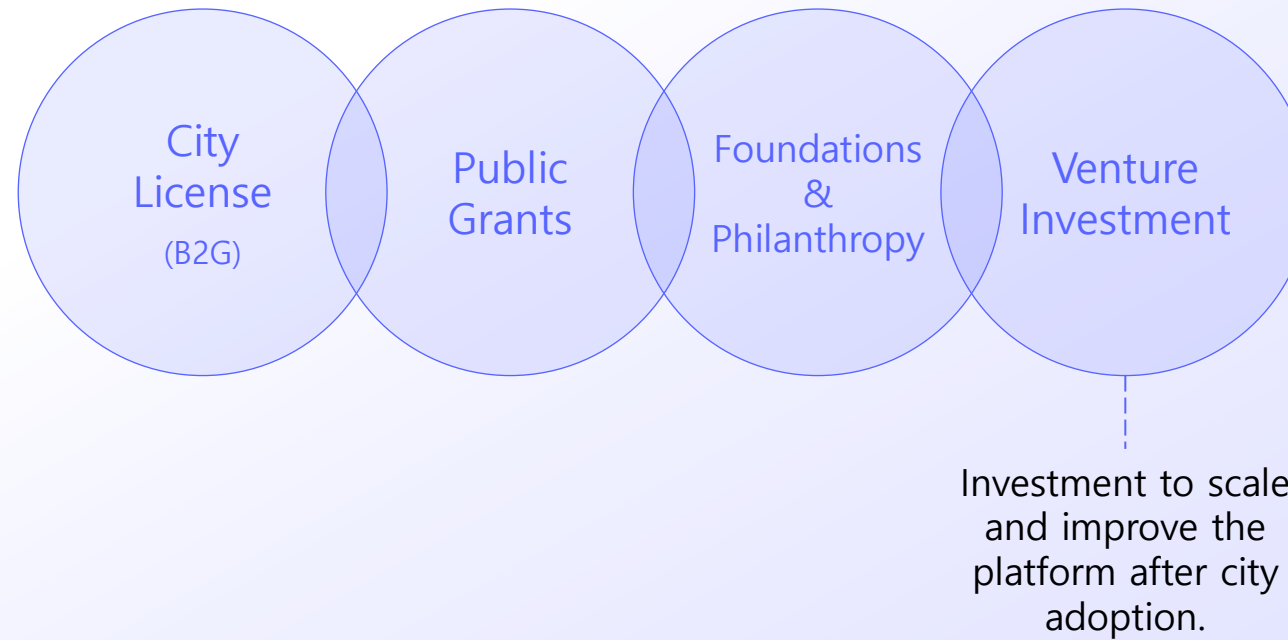
[Business Model : Funding Sources]



[Business Model : Funding Sources]



[Business Model : Funding Sources]



[Survey Insights]

TARGET : 18 local residents

METHOD : ~3 min interview after concept briefing



Positive
61% (11)

Positive
61%
11 people



Transparency & public status updates

Strong interest in seeing progress communicated openly and consistently.



Reward-based motivation

Expected to increase participation and repeat engagement when well-designed



Neutral
28% (5)

Neutral
28%
5 people



Operational sustainability & resourcing

Questions about ongoing staffing needs, response time, and long-term sustainability.



Reward model needs validation

Concerns about unintended incentives ; requested clearer rules and evaluation.



Negative
11% (2)

Negative
11%
2 people



Vote manipulation & coordination

Worried about organized voting and agenda pushing if safeguards are weak.



Privacy & participation fatigue

Hesitation about public exposure, conflict, and the effort required to engage.

Thank You

Q&A